



Hiroshima Lexical Research Forum

H-LRF 2026

September 19th & 20th, 2026

Book of Abstracts

H-LRF 2026

How to Participate

This year's H-LRF will be held on Saturday, September 19th and Sunday, September 20th. All of the day's of the conference will be held using the same Zoom session. You will be able to join the Zoom session by clicking on the link below during the conference times.

Zoom Link:

<https://bit.ly/hlrf2026zoom>

Full Zoom link

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pwd=WHa0PkUzFEaBqY4SFFSVKmqQ8NmN8Xf.1&from=addon](https://us02web.zoom.us/j/84056096592?pwd=WHa0PkUzFEaBqY4SFFSVKmqQ8NmN8Xf.1&from=addon)



Click on the link or scan
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The **conference schedule** can be found here:

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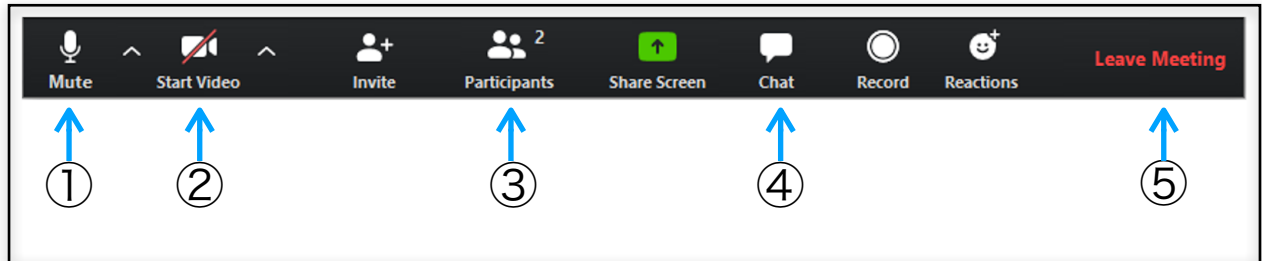
Zoom Etiquette:

To ensure that everyone gets the most out of this year's conference, we have included a few requests regarding Zoom etiquette below.

- Please ensure that your microphone is muted when the presenter is talking
- We want the discussions to be as interactive as possible, so please feel free to use the Chat feature to ask and answer questions or make comments during the presentation.
- While the speaker will (probably) not be able to respond to your question during their presentation, we will have a question-and-answer session at the end of each talk.
- If you have a question you would like to ask, please use the “raise your hand” feature of Zoom after the speaker has finished presenting.
- When asking your questions during the question and answer session, please ask your questions orally and ensure that both your microphone and camera are turned on.

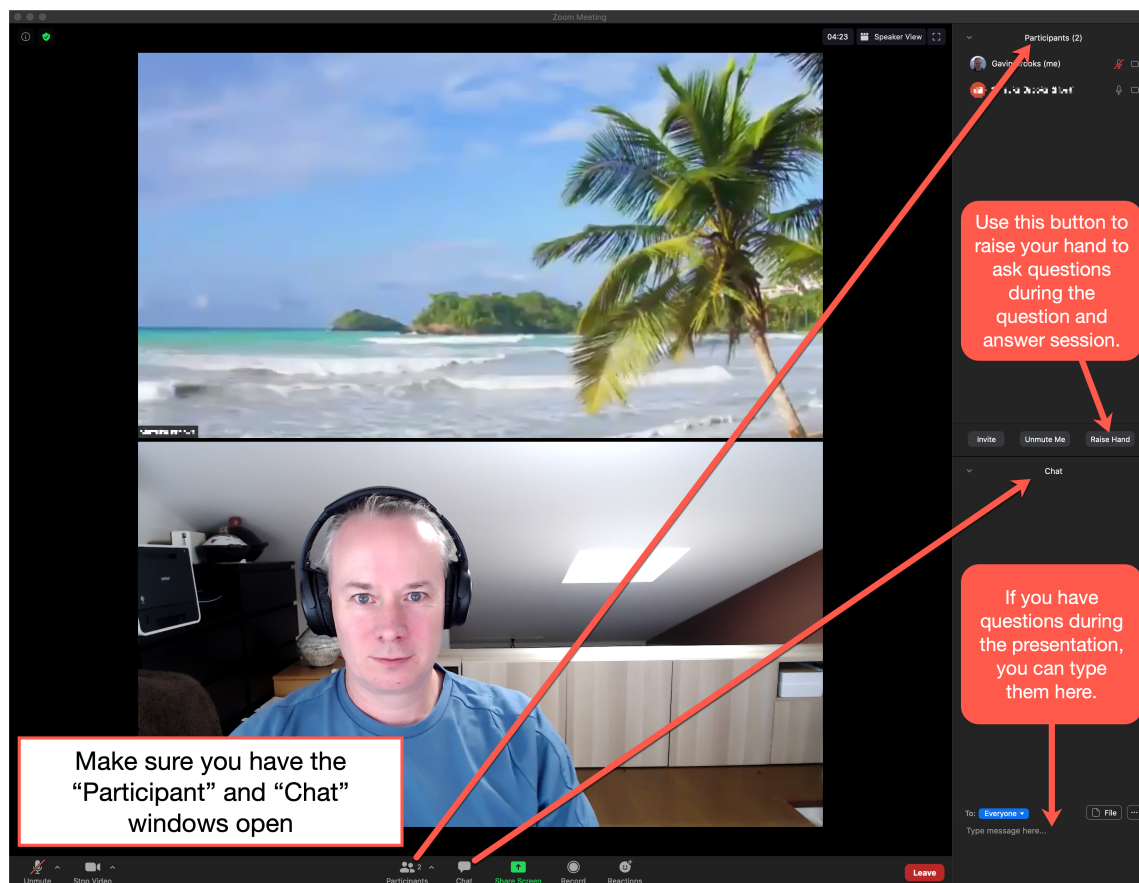
Using Zoom:

This year's H-LRF will be delivered using Zoom. While I am sure that everyone is very familiar with Zoom at this point in time, we have included a few simple instructions and requests to ensure that the conference runs smoothly.



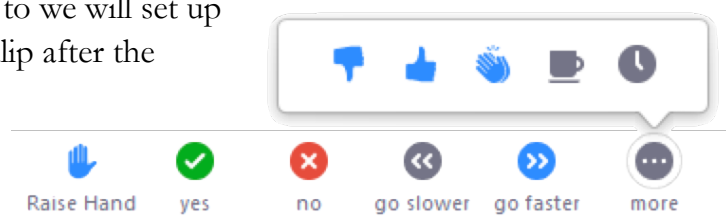
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- As soon as you log in, make sure your video ② and microphone ① are turned on. To make things easier, please mute your microphone when presenters are talking, as background noise from audience members' microphones could cause Zoom to shift focus away from the presenter.
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- Make sure that your name is visible in the participants window, as this is the name that the session chair will see when you are asking questions.
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Asking questions:

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- You can ask questions during the presentation using the Chat feature of Zoom.
- We want these sessions to be as interactive as possible, so please feel free to respond to other audience members' comments or questions in the Chat box.
- After the presenter finishes, there will be time for questions and answers. These will be done orally. To ask a question:
- Raise your hand using the "Raise Hand" button in Zoom.
- The session chair will call on the audience members in the order in which they raised their hands.
- When your name is called, please turn on your microphone and ask your question to the presenter.
- Due to time constraints, we may not get to all of the questions. If you have a question that you wanted to ask but were not able to we will set up a question channel in the H-LRF Zulip after the conference and continue the discussion there.



Multiword Units in L2 Vocabulary Testing: A Critical Examination

Presenter: Ayako Aizawa, *Rikkyo University*

Contributing authors: Kohei Fukuda, *Tokyo University of Foreign Studies*; Yusuke Kuroki, *Michigan State University*

The use of multiword units (MWUs) has been considered an indicator of second language (L2) proficiency (e.g., Boers et al, 2006; Tavakoli & Uchihara, 2020). Over the past decades, a growing number of studies have focused on MWUs, leading to the development and use of various measures to assess L2 learners' knowledge of MWUs (e.g., Gyllstad, 2020). However, the field has yet to reach a consensus on how best to assess MWUs, and no assessment has been widely accepted as the standard (Boers & Lindstromberg, 2009; Gyllstad & Schmitt, 2018). This current situation suggests a lack of comprehensive understanding regarding the test design, what the tests actually measure, and their validity and reliability. To address this gap, this study will critically examine existing MWU tests. This examination will focus on their design and administration, and the reported evidence for their validity and reliability, which we will analyze through a thorough review of the accompanying literature for each test. In addition, as an extension of our critical review, we will conduct a corpus-driven analysis of the linguistic features. This will involve employing consistent association measures to analyze the representativeness and commonality of MWUs across different tests. By integrating the test items into a unified corpus, we aim to uncover the extent to which these tests differentiate their assessment of MWU knowledge, addressing concerns about potential redundancy and the ecological validity of the tested items. This research aims to contribute to a more comprehensive understanding of current MWU test characteristics and the scope of their supporting documentation, highlighting areas for improvement. Our findings are expected to inform the design and reporting of future MWU tests, enabling test users to more effectively select instruments that align with their specific measurement goals.

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The Semitic Paradigm: Vocabulary Depth Hierarchies in L2 Hebrew

Presenter(s): Eihab Abu-Rabiah, *Kaye Academic College of Education, Ben-Gurion University of the Negev*

Second language (L2) vocabulary knowledge comprises two complementary dimensions: breadth, referring to the number of words a learner knows, and depth, referring to the richness and complexity of knowledge associated with each word. Vocabulary depth acquisition is a gradual, multidimensional process in which receptive knowledge typically precedes productive knowledge, and the form–meaning link constitutes the most basic and accessible component of lexical knowledge. Research on L2 vocabulary depth has mainly focused on Indo-European languages, showing that inflectional and derivational morphology are among the most challenging aspects. Far less is known about Semitic languages, where root-and-pattern morphology shapes lexical processing. In Hebrew, the developmental patterns of productive vocabulary depth across meaning and use remain unclear, and it is uncertain whether lexical difficulty hierarchies observed in Indo-European languages extend to Semitic contexts.

Thirty high-frequency Hebrew words were assessed among 34 Arabic-speaking learners of Hebrew through a recall-based discrete-point test (180 items, yielding 6,120 responses) across five aspects: definitions, synonyms, antonyms, inflections (gender, number, person), and phraseology.

The study revealed a clear hierarchy of difficulty in productive vocabulary depth knowledge. Learners exhibited high accuracy in tasks requiring basic definitional knowledge (87.65%), followed by inflections of number (77.75%) and gender/person (70.59%). In contrast, performance was significantly weaker in tasks demanding nuanced lexical knowledge, with accuracy rates dropping to 44.31% for antonyms, 33.24% for phraseology, and 29.90% for synonyms. Pairwise comparisons showed significant differences across most vocabulary-depth knowledge aspects, except synonyms and phraseology.

The results highlight uneven development in productive vocabulary depth knowledge, with meaning recall and morphology more accessible than semantic associations and phraseological knowledge. They extend lexical depth hierarchy research beyond Indo-European contexts, underscoring both universal and language-specific patterns in L2 lexical development.

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Evaluating the Efficacy of Data-Driven Learning and Input Enhancement Approaches on Grammatical Collocations in Saudi EFL Learners

Presenter(s): Abeer Alenezi, *Bangor University*

This experimental study will investigate the impact of Data-Driven Learning (DDL) and Input Enhancement (IE) approaches on Saudi EFL learners' acquisition of grammatical collocations (GCs), particularly prepositional collocations. Additionally, it will explore learners' perceptions of these approaches. Data-Driven Learning (DDL) approach involves corpus-based techniques (e.g., frequency analysis, concordancing), while Input Enhancement (IE) approach employs visual modifications (e.g., bolding, underlining) to highlight target collocations in texts. The study is grounded in three key theoretical frameworks: Firth's (1957) contextual theory of meaning and Schmidt's (1990, 2001) noticing hypothesis.

The research incorporates a mixed-methods approach, combining quantitative assessment through pre- and post-tests. The grammatical collocation tests were developed to measure two key aspects of language proficiency: receptive knowledge, which refers to the ability to identify and comprehend collocations, and productive knowledge, which involves accurately producing collocations in context. Each test component was systematically structured to align with its respective knowledge type, ensuring a comprehensive evaluation of learners' collocational competence. A survey questionnaire with qualitative data gathered through open-ended questions. This mixed-methods approach enables a comprehensive evaluation of how these instructional methods affect Saudi EFL learners' acquisition of prepositional grammatical collocations in both receptive and productive contexts.

The Effects of Proficiency on Incidental Learning of Words versus Multiword Expressions

Presenter(s): Mahnaz Aliyar, *Victoria University of Wellington*

Vocabulary knowledge underpins second language (L2) proficiency, and a considerable portion of it develops incidentally through meaning-focused reading. Authentic comics, which include written text with visual imagery, offer a promising yet under-researched medium for such learning, providing rich contextual and pictorial cues that may scaffold the uptake of unfamiliar lexical items. A critical but unanswered question is whether learning of single words and multiword expressions (MWEs) benefit equally from these affordances, and whether any such difference depends on learner proficiency. MWEs, with their often semi-fixed and non-compositional nature, pose learning challenges distinct from those of single words, yet the interaction between lexical type, contextual support, and proficiency has received limited empirical attention in authentic multimodal contexts.

This study investigates how proficiency level shapes the incidental acquisition of single words versus MWEs from pleasure reading of an authentic English-language comic. Two groups of 40 Chinese learners of English, one advanced and one intermediate, each read the comic *Kampung Boy: Yesterday and Today* (Lat, 1993) once during their leisure time. The text features occasional Malay lexical items, 20 of which (11 single words, nine MWEs) served as target vocabulary and were treated as pseudowords. These items appeared under four naturally occurring conditions: pictorial support, in-text glossing, combined (multimodal) support, and no support. Uptake was assessed immediately and after a three-week delay through form recognition, meaning recall, and meaning recognition tests.

Grounded in dual coding and multimedia learning frameworks, and using mixed-effects modelling, the analysis compares how learner proficiency interacts with support type and lexical type across the three dimensions of vocabulary knowledge. The study seeks to advance theoretical understanding of how proficiency moderates the incidental learning of single words and MWEs from authentic multimodal input, and to inform the pedagogical use of comics, glossing, and imagery in L2 vocabulary instruction.

References

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Perceived Narrator Effects on Incidental Vocabulary Learning and Eye Movements

Presenter(s): Alexandre Gaspar Mendes Alves, *University of Macau*

Contributing Authors: Barry Lee Reynolds, *University of Macau*; Brian Vincent Rusk, *University of Macau*

Reading while listening has been shown to facilitate comprehension and vocabulary development in second language (L2) contexts, yet little is known about how learners' attitudes toward Artificial Intelligence (AI) versus human voices may influence incidental vocabulary learning and online reading behaviour during reading while listening. Addressing this gap, the present study examined whether L2 English learners' perceived narrator type (AI-perceived vs. human-perceived narration) affected (a) incidental acquisition of target vocabulary items and (b) eye-movement patterns during reading while listening. Sixty university learners completed a vocabulary pre- and post-test measuring form-recognition and meaning-recall, two reading while listening activities with eye tracking, comprehension checks, and an AI perception questionnaire. Multilevel logistic regression analyses revealed robust vocabulary gains from pre-test to post-test; however, perceived narrator type did not significantly predict form-recognition or meaning-recall outcomes. Learning-focused models showed that dwell time was the strongest predictor of form-recognition learning, whereas meaning-recall was more strongly associated with frequency of exposure and comprehension. Eye-tracking analyses further showed that perceived narrator type did not modulate word fixation probability, gaze synchronisation with narration, or temporal alignment of first fixations. Readers typically progressed ahead of the audio stream, confirming a reading-ahead profile characteristic of reading while listening. Overall, the findings indicate that incidental vocabulary learning during reading while listening is shaped by attentional allocation and frequency of exposure rather than by narrator framing. These results suggest that AI-generated voices can be used in reading while listening without compromising lexical learning, with implications for pedagogy, multimedia material design, and future research employing AI-generated stimuli.

Rhetorical Structure and Lexical Features of Abstracts and Full Texts

Presenter(s): Motoko Asano, *Osaka Medical and Pharmaceutical University*; Kaori Sakakibara, *Osaka Medical and Pharmaceutical University*; Miho Fujieda, *Osaka Medical and Pharmaceutical University*

Contributing Authors: Tomoko Wakasa, *Kindai University Nara Hospital*; Yoshinori Miyazaki, *Shizuoka University*

This study is part of a larger project investigating linguistic features of the abstracts and full texts of medical research articles. Research article abstracts are a “representation” of “the article as a whole” (Swales, 1990, p. 179) and are typically “written in tightly worded sentences” (Graetz, 1985, p. 125). Abstracts may therefore contain sentences in which multiple rhetorical functions are realized through lexical choices that contribute to “framing the article that it precedes” (Hyland, 2000, p. 64). To investigate this relationship, the present study combined move analysis with lexical analysis of abstracts and corresponding full texts of 15 medical research articles.

First, drawing on Swales’s (1981, 1990) move-analytical framework, we analyzed their rhetorical organization. We used the term move-step to refer to rhetorical units at the step level. Move-steps were identified on the basis of the communicative purposes realized by text fragments within each sentence. Rather than labeling the fragments themselves, we coded each sentence for the move-steps realized by its constituent parts, allowing multiple move-steps to be assigned to a single sentence. Of the 34 move-steps identified, 19 (56%) occurred in the abstracts, whereas all 34 occurred in the full texts.

Second, we examined lexical features of sentences realizing the same move-steps in the abstracts and full texts. As an initial analysis, we focused on single sentences that realized the communicative functions of describing experimental procedures and enhancing the transparency of research procedures. In these sentences, noun phrases accounted for about half of the words in the abstracts and about 30% in the full texts. This difference suggests that abstracts may achieve greater textual condensation through more intensive use of noun phrases, even when the same combination of rhetorical functions is realized. Further analyses will examine lexical levels across move-steps shared by the abstracts and full texts.

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Development and Initial Validation of COLLAT: A Collocation Awareness Instrument

Presenter(s): Chi Cuong Chau, *University of Macau*; Barry Lee Reynolds, *University of Macau*

Research on multiword expressions (MWEs)—including collocations, idioms, and lexical bundles—has advanced substantially; however, most assessments focus on accuracy- and knowledge-oriented measures rather than the awareness processes underlying that knowledge. This article reports the development and initial validity evidence of the Collocation Awareness Assessment Tool (COLLAT), a theoretically grounded instrument operationalizing collocation awareness across three dimensions: cognitive noticing, metacognitive awareness, and metalinguistic awareness through identification, self-report, and binary forced-choice judgment tasks, respectively, with the first two accompanied by written justifications. Data from 162 Vietnamese university EFL learners were analyzed within an argument-based validation framework. Signal detection analysis operationalized cognitive noticing as the discrimination of target collocations from non-target word combinations in context, distinguishing perceptual sensitivity (d') from response criterion (c). The self-report component exhibited an interpretable unidimensional structure with acceptable reliability. Rasch modeling of the judgment task indicated orderly item difficulty, although targeting favored lower-to-mid ability and precision was limited at the upper range. Mixed-effects modeling supported the cross-model consistency of item difficulty estimates. Analyses of relationships among the three COLLAT components revealed limited alignment between quantitative performance indices and qualitative reasoning depth. Overall, findings provide initial support for interpreting cognitive noticing, metacognitive awareness, and metalinguistic awareness as related but potentially separable aspects of collocation awareness. COLLAT may therefore complement knowledge-focused collocation assessments by providing diagnostic and research-oriented evidence about how learners notice, evaluate, and explain collocations.

Diminished Mnemonic Advantage of Alliterative Phrases in Silent Reading

Presenter(s): Yinhui Gao, *University of Macau*

Contributing Authors: Barry Lee Reynolds, *University of Macau*, Brian V. Rusk, *University of Macau*

Previous research has suggested that alliterative phrases may enjoy a mnemonic advantage in second language (L2) learning, particularly under learning conditions that provide auditory input or explicitly direct learners' attention to phonological form. However, it remains unclear whether this advantage persists under silent reading conditions, whether it extends beyond receptive learning outcomes, and whether the mnemonic advantage of alliterative phrases is associated with greater attention allocation during reading. To address these research gaps, the present study investigated two questions. First, it examined whether alliterative phrases are more memorable than non-alliterative phrases for L2 English learners across different dimensions of phrase knowledge during silent reading, using both receptive and productive measures of phrase knowledge. Second, it investigated whether alliterative phrases attract greater visual attention during reading, using eye-tracking to capture learners' attention allocation in real time. Fifty-five participants completed a pretest, an immediate post-test and delayed post-test assessing receptive form knowledge (recognition), receptive form-meaning relation knowledge (recall) and productive form-meaning relation knowledge (recall). Results showed no significant mnemonic advantage for alliterative phrases over non-alliterative phrases in any test. Nor did alliterative phrases receive significantly longer total reading times. These findings contribute to a more nuanced understanding of the conditions under which phonological salience facilitates L2 phrase learning, suggesting that the mnemonic advantage of alliterative phrases is not automatically triggered by visual exposure alone but may depend on learning conditions that support phonological processing.

Vocabulary Support on Learner Engagement During Viewing and Vocabulary Learning

Presenter(s): Misaki Hatakeyama, *Toboku University*

Contributing Authors: Gaia Oikawa, *Toboku University*; Takumi Uchihara, *Toboku University*

This study investigates the effects of vocabulary instruction on learner's task engagement, flow, and vocabulary learning through video viewing, as well as the role of task motivation in these outcomes. Task engagement refers to learner's heightened attention to and involvement in a task across multiple dimensions (Philp & Duchesne, 2016). Given the individual nature of video viewing, the present study focuses on cognitive and emotional engagement. Although pre-teaching vocabulary may facilitate comprehension by reducing the burden of unknown words, such support may also alter how learners attend to and experience meaning-focused viewing. Approximately 280 Japanese university students participated in a four-week classroom study and were assigned to pre-teaching, post-teaching, or test-only control conditions. Participants in the two experimental conditions viewed an approximately 11-minute episode of *Our Planet 2* with vocabulary instruction administered either before or after viewing. Vocabulary learning was assessed through form recognition, meaning recall, and meaning recognition tests administered two weeks before the treatment and one week afterward. Cognitive and emotional engagement and flow were measured using post-viewing questionnaires. Task motivation was conceptualized through situated expectancy-value theory (SEVT; Eccles & Wigfield, 2020), encompassing expectancy for success, subjective task value, and perceived task costs, and was measured prior to the main treatment. The study examines whether instructional timing differentially affects engagement, flow, and vocabulary learning, and whether task motivation is associated with these outcomes. By examining both psychological and lexical consequences of instructional timing, this study seeks to inform vocabulary support in meaning-focused video viewing. Additionally, follow-up interviews were conducted to gain a more detailed understanding of the learner's cognitive and emotional experiences during viewing. The results will be presented and discussed at the conference.

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Listener Background and the Evaluation of Spoken L2 English Lexis

Presenter(s): Philip Head, *Osaka Jogakuin University*

English L2 speech evaluation test results can have important impacts on future education, employment, and immigration opportunities (Munro, 2008). However, the use of human raters in speech evaluation introduces the possibility of rater bias stemming from their backgrounds (e.g., Carey et al., 2011; Isaacs & Thomson, 2013; Winke et al., 2013). This study involved 203 listeners with different background factors rating speech samples from 44 English L2 speakers (31 Japanese L1, eight Thai L1, and five Bengali L1). The listener background factors examined included the listener's L1 (English, Japanese, and Other L1s), previous teaching experience, location (Canada or Japan), and sex. The speech samples were rated on a nine-point scale for seven aspects of speech (overall comprehensibility, fluency and coherence, lexical resources, grammatical range and accuracy, segmental accuracy, chunking, and intonation). Many facet Rasch measurement (MRFM) analyses found significant bias/interaction effects between the speaker's L1 and the four listener background factors examined for all aspects of speech except for lexical resources. In addition, listeners were asked to identify which aspect of speech was the easiest and the most difficult to rate and give a reason for their choice. The qualitative responses were coded, and response frequencies were compared by listener background factors. The results showed that listeners with teaching experience were significantly more likely than those without experience to state that lexis was easy to rate. This presentation will discuss the reasons given by raters regarding what makes lexis either easy or difficult to rate in a speaking test and the implications for English L2 speech evaluation by human raters.

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Learner Autonomy and Vocabulary Choice on an Online Platform

Presenter(s): Marshall Kiyoshi Higa, *Institute of Foreign Language Research and Education, Hiroshima University*

Vocabulary acquisition remains a central challenge for Japanese EFL learners, who often have limited opportunity for incidental exposure to English outside the classroom. Online vocabulary learning platforms, which increasingly draw on autonomous learning principles, data-driven word analysis, and spaced repetition, offer a promising way to support vocabulary study, but questions remain about how such platforms are used within course curricula and about the nature of the vocabulary learners choose to study when given autonomy over their own word lists. This study examines usage and word-selection patterns among 188 students in a general English course at a Japanese national university, drawn from nine academic departments, in which an online vocabulary learning platform was provided as a supplementary resource over an eight-week period and participation was incorporated into course grading. Drawing on platform analytics, the study examines the relationship between students' engagement and their graded participation, and the relationship between the source of students' self-selected texts (e.g., academic, news, encyclopedia) and the academic-department alignment and difficulty level of the vocabulary they chose to study. Findings indicate that graded engagement produced meaningful but uneven participation across departments; that students overwhelmingly selected news media over academic or field-specific texts; and that the resulting vocabulary was concentrated in high-frequency bands, with department-aligned word choice emerging primarily when students independently sought out field-specific reading material. These patterns suggest that learner autonomy, when unguided, tends toward general rather than specialized vocabulary. The findings contribute to a growing body of research using platform analytics to understand vocabulary learning behavior beyond test-score outcomes alone, with implications for how such platforms might be integrated into general English courses serving students from diverse academic backgrounds and for how instructors might scaffold text selection to support field-relevant vocabulary growth.

Beyond Monologues: Predicting L2 Fluency in Academic Multilogues

Presenter(s): Christopher J. Hollis, *Hiroshima University / Tottori University*

Contributing Authors: Jon Clenton, *Hiroshima University*; Gavin Brooks, *Kyoto University of Foreign Studies*; Jen Jordan, *Kwansei Gakuin University*; Daniel Hougham, *Hiroshima University*

Multi-word sequences (MWSs) are processed more efficiently than non-formulaic language and support L2 oral production (Conklin & Schmitt, 2012), yet fluency research has overwhelmingly focused on monologic speech (Hougham et al., 2024). This remains a critical gap given that lexical bundles (LBs) are central to academic interaction, where speakers coordinate turns and negotiate meaning in real time (Mauranen, 2012). Furthermore, while MWSs associate with oral fluency across proficiency levels (Tavakoli & Uchihara, 2020), the relationship between bundle length and fluency in multilogues (interactions involving three or more speakers) remains unexplored. This study examines how LB length and frequency predict L2 fluency in academic multilogues across proficiency levels among L1 Japanese learners of English.

Speech data were elicited from 120 L1 Japanese (L2 English) participants grouped by CEFR level (A2–C1; $n = 30$ per level) based on an a priori power analysis. Participants completed interactive academic multilogue tasks. Audio and transcripts were analyzed using a structured five-phase framework combining acoustic measurement in PRAAT with a retrospective, nine-category interactional timeline (distinguishing categories such as own pauses, listener pauses, transition gaps, overlaps, and shared silence). To ensure data integrity during turn-taking analysis, simultaneous speech transitions were explicitly treated as distinct overlap events rather than conflated with zero-latency turn latencies. Following Hougham et al. (2024), LBs were evaluated using text-internal and text-external approaches: TAALES 2.0 identified shorter LBs against a spoken reference corpus (COCA), while AntConc identified four-word bundles. Longer bundles were manually refined against clause boundaries. Linear mixed-effects models assessed LB–fluency relationships across proficiency tiers.

Drawing on evidence that longer MWSs reduce cognitive planning load (Kormos, 2006), findings address how bundle length differentially impacts breakdown fluency and speech rate within dynamic conversational floors. By integrating corpus tools with interactional phonetics, this paper advances understanding of formulaic language in spoken multilogues.

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Research-based Lexical Targets in Education and Teaching Materials

Presenter(s): Batia Laufer, *University of Haifa*

Non-native language users operate with significantly limited vocabularies compared to native speakers. This reality presents fundamental challenges for school education regarding the required lexical targets and their implementation in teaching materials.

Textbook design is particularly critical, as textbooks serve as the primary medium through which lexical items are introduced, practiced, and recycled. Ideally, they should align closely with the lexical targets established by educational systems. Yet research across multiple contexts reveals persistent problems: textbooks often lack clear vocabulary selection criteria, fail to match learners' proficiency levels, provide inadequate recycling of lexical items, and do not appear to be grounded in research-based principles (Antes, 2025; Bergström et al., 2025; Biseko, 2025; Brown, 2011; Konstantakis & Alexiou, 2012; López-Jiménez, 2014; Sun & Dang, 2020).

This presentation demonstrates how empirical research on vocabulary learning has informed the principled construction of a lexical syllabus for elementary and secondary education, subsequently implemented in school textbooks. The syllabus incorporates key research findings regarding: the amount of lexis necessary for performing language tasks; type of words necessary for such performance; distinctions between receptive and productive knowledge; relationships between proficiency levels and word counting units; L1 influence; multiple word meanings; the importance and acquisition of multi-word units. The implementation of the lexical syllabus in the textbooks has been informed by research findings regarding effects of repeated exposures, spacing, and recycling; and optimal types of vocabulary activities (Laufer, 2020; Nakata, 2015; Nation, 2015).

The result is a set of uniform, country-wide word lists spanning Grades 4-12 (CEFR Pre-A1 to B2), with all target words systematically integrated into level-appropriate textbooks through both texts and exercises. I examine the interface between research and policy-making, illustrating how accessible, sound research evidence can inform effective educational decision-making.

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How Effective Is L2 Incidental Collocation Learning? A Multilevel Meta-Analysis

Presenter(s): Muhan Li, *Toboku University*

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As the most extensively researched type of formulaic sequence in SLA, collocation is regarded as essential for proficient L2 use (Sonbul & Siyanova-Chanturia, 2024). However, given their vast number and the limited time available for classroom instruction, teaching collocations through word-focused activities is not always feasible. Consequently, a number of studies have investigated the effectiveness of incidental collocation learning. While many studies reveal that exposure to meaning-focused input—such as reading stories, listening to music, and viewing television—can yield substantial learning gains, others have reported only limited gains, arguing that collocations often go unnoticed due to their high semantic transparency and low perceptual salience (e.g., Szukalski, 2012).

Given these mixed findings, the present meta-analysis, as the first of its kind, aims to examine the overall effectiveness of incidental collocation learning and identify moderators that may account for variability in learning gains across studies. A three-level meta-analytic model was fitted to a dataset of 115 effect sizes extracted from 28 eligible studies. The results revealed a statistically significant, large effect ($g = 1.26$, $p < .0001$). This finding is comparable to that reported in Webb et al.'s (2023) meta-analysis on the effectiveness of incidental single-word learning ($g = 1.14$), suggesting that meaning-focused treatments for collocation learning may yield greater effectiveness than previously assumed. Subsequent moderator analyses examined 14 variables and identified five significant sources of heterogeneity: L1 congruency, frequency of occurrence, test format, L2 proficiency, and treatment duration. Specifically, larger effect sizes were observed in studies targeting congruent collocations, providing more encounters with target items, employing form-recognition tests, involving novice learners, and implementing treatments over multiple days. These findings underscore the importance of considering learner-, treatment-, and methodology-related factors when evaluating the effectiveness of incidental collocation learning. The study concludes with evidence-based pedagogical implications for optimizing incidental collocation learning.

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Locus of Translation Priming Effect: Shared Concept or Form-Level Association?

Presenter(s): Yoan Linon, *Tohoku University*

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In the present study, we examined how translation equivalents are linked in the bilingual mental lexicon. Some bilingual models assume that translation equivalents are linked through their shared concept (Multilink, Dijkstra et al., 2018). Other models assume the two words are also connected through a form-level paired association (RHM, Kroll & Stewart, 1994). We used the masked translation priming paradigm to examine the extent to which each link ties translation equivalents together. It has been well established that L2 targets are recognized faster when they are primed by their L1 translation equivalents than by unrelated L1 words, and the facilitation effect is assumed to occur because primes-target pairs share underlying links across languages. Taking advantage of the Japanese language, we teased apart facilitation via conceptual link and via form-level paired association by manipulating visual familiarity of Japanese translation primes. Our critical primes were either visually familiar Kanji primes (e.g., 真珠) or visually unfamiliar Katakana-transcribed primes (e.g., シンジュ), paired with English targets (e.g., PEARL). With Kanji primes, both form-level and conceptual links are intact. With Katakana-transcribed primes, form-level association is lost, but they still retain a conceptual link by relying on a phonological-to-conceptual route. In Experiment 1, we demonstrated that Katakana-transcribed primes can facilitate their base Kanji word targets, confirming that these primes can facilitate targets when underlying links exist. In Experiment 2, using Kanji primes, we observed a significant translation priming effect, replicating previous studies (Nakayama et al., 2012, 2013). Experiment 3 was our critical test, using Katakana-transcribed primes. Critically, Katakana-transcribed primes produced no priming effect. The lack of translation priming suggests that form-level paired association, as assumed in RHM, is a critical link that ties translation equivalents, challenging Multilink's assumption that translation equivalents are linked only via shared concepts.

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Measuring Spoken Vocabulary Knowledge: Word-Level Accentedness and Comprehensibility

Presenter(s): Soma Sekiguchi, *Toboku University*; Ryuya Komuro, *Toboku University*; Yui Suzukida, *University College London & Toboku University*; Takumi Uchihara, *Toboku University*

This study examines the validity of word-level accentedness and comprehensibility as measures of L2 pronunciation knowledge and provides methodological implications in L2 vocabulary research. Previous L2 pronunciation research has extensively evaluated sentence-level or passage-level speech in terms of intelligibility (whether listeners can correctly identify what is said), accentedness (the extent to which speech differs from an expected target-language norm), and comprehensibility (the perceived ease or difficulty of understanding speech) (e.g., Munro & Derwing, 1995a). In L2 vocabulary research, however, L2 pronunciation has received little attention (Uchihara, 2022), although being classified as an important aspect of spoken word knowledge in vocabulary frameworks (Nation, 2022).

In the present study, five American English speakers, 10 Japanese speakers of English, and 10 Chinese speakers of English produced 50 English words in several pronunciation styles, producing 2,250 audio recordings in total. The recordings were divided into 20 blocks of 25 words. Each of the 224 L1 American English listeners was randomly assigned four blocks (100 words) to evaluate for intelligibility, accentedness, and comprehensibility. That is, each recording was evaluated by at least four different listeners. Intelligibility was operationalized as transcription accuracy, whereas accentedness and comprehensibility were rated on nine-point Likert scales. A preliminary analysis, such as multi-facet Rasch analysis controlling for item difficulty and rater severity, revealed a pattern consistent with previous findings from L2 pronunciation research: greater accentedness did not necessarily correspond to lower comprehensibility even at the word level. In other words, words perceived as strongly accented could still be relatively easy for listeners to understand.

These findings support the use of word-level accentedness and comprehensibility as measures of productive spoken word knowledge, extending vocabulary assessment beyond form-meaning knowledge to how effectively learned forms can be understood in communication.

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Pairs vs. Quizlet: Vocabulary Gains Across Aspects of Word Knowledge

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Facilitating vocabulary learning is a central task for language teachers, yet little research compares the relative efficacy of different vocabulary tasks (Webb, et al. 2020), and less still the effect of learner grouping, with one exception being Iwata et al. (2024). When selecting words for study, one important variable is grapheme-phoneme consistency — how closely a word's spelling matches its pronunciation — which may complicate acquisition some aspects of word knowledge due to the relatively high number of English words with low grapheme-phoneme consistency (Share, 2008). This study aims to bring together these elements to compare paired and individual vocabulary study and asks whether high- or low-consistency words are more readily acquired in either condition. 140 Japanese learners were assigned to a paired or individual condition and studied 28 target words across three sessions, with half of the words introduced in each of the first two sessions and all 28 reviewed in the third. The individual group studied alone in a written mode, using progressively demanding Quizlet tasks; the paired group worked primarily in an oral/aural mode, moving from meaning recognition and meaning recall to form recognition and form recall. Pre and posttests comprised 56 items covering oral receptive knowledge (14 items), written productive (14 items) knowledge, and form recognition (all 28 items). No significant difference emerged between conditions on meaning recognition or form recall, but the paired group outperformed the Quizlet group on oral meaning recall. Grapheme-phoneme consistency did not affect acquisition of aural forms, though low-consistency words were recalled significantly more accurately in the written productive posttests. Pedagogical implications of these findings are discussed as are directions for future research.

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Mapping Discipline-Relevant Vocabulary in Introductory Agronomy and Applied Linguistics Textbooks

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Teachers of agricultural English have to decide which words to put on next week's vocabulary list, with very little to go on. Students meet English in textbooks, journal articles, lectures and communication in the field, and the commercial materials available in Japan are not necessarily corpus-based. Agricultural word lists do exist: Bunparit and Kongcharoen (2025) derived one from 6.8 million words of research articles. What such lists leave out is the specialised sense. Most of this work counts forms or families rather than senses, draws on written texts alone, and has not been tried with learners. A learner who knows *stand* will not know that in agronomy a stand is the density of emerged crops in a field, and a headword list leaves that gap unmarked.

This presentation reports a preliminary study towards such a list. We treated words listed in a textbook's index as items the book itself marks as discipline-relevant, and asked how they are distributed across high-frequency (GSL 1 and 2), academic (AWL) and other vocabulary. Using AntWordProfiler, we compared an introductory agronomy textbook (Sheaffer & Moncada, 2012; 143,776 tokens) with an introductory applied linguistics textbook (Schmitt & Rodgers, 2020; 134,040 tokens). Index-listed words account for 56.83% of agronomy tokens and 43.96% of applied linguistics tokens. Of index types, 65.16% fall outside the GSL and the AWL in agronomy but only 42.38% in applied linguistics, where academic vocabulary is much better represented (22.00% of index types, against 7.73% in agronomy). Of the 640 types shared by the agronomy index and glossary, a third are high-frequency words, which suggests that stripping out high-frequency and academic vocabulary before keyword extraction would lose familiar words carrying specialised senses.

Index membership marks disciplinary importance, not technicality, and such clues are less accurate than Chung and Nation's (2004) four-step rating scale, so these items are candidates only: the agronomy index also holds function words and words used in general senses. The next step is to replicate and extend Chung and Nation (2003), with subject experts rating vocabulary from agronomy, applied linguistics and anatomy. The longer-term aim is an openly available corpus and a sense-level list for agriculture.

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Effects of Enhanced Bilingual Subtitles on Comprehension and Vocabulary Learning

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Bilingual subtitles can help second language learners understand audiovisual materials (Dizon & Thanyawatpokin, 2021). However, learners may pay insufficient attention to unfamiliar L2 word forms when viewing videos with bilingual subtitles (Wang & Pellicer-Sánchez, 2022). Textual enhancement, such as highlighting target words and their translations, may draw learners' attention to vocabulary and support vocabulary learning (e.g., Baleghizadeh & Mohajer, 2025; Li et al., 2026). The current study investigated the effects of textually enhanced bilingual subtitles on students' incidental learning of English vocabulary at a Japanese university.

Participants were randomly assigned to either a standard bilingual subtitle group or a textually enhanced bilingual subtitle group, in which the English target words and their Japanese translations were highlighted. They first completed the updated Vocabulary Levels Test (uVLT) to assess their general vocabulary knowledge and a vocabulary pretest (i.e., meaning recall) to measure their prior knowledge of the 36 target items. After watching the video, they completed an immediate posttest measuring form recognition, meaning recognition, and meaning recall. A delayed posttest was administered approximately two weeks later to examine vocabulary retention. Video comprehension was also assessed immediately after viewing. Two questionnaires examined participants' perceptions of the subtitles and their learning experience.

Vocabulary test responses are analyzed using GLMMs. The study also examines whether the frequency of target-word occurrence affects vocabulary learning. Video comprehension scores are compared between the two subtitle conditions. It is hypothesized that textual enhancement will promote vocabulary learning by making the connections between English word forms and their Japanese meanings more noticeable. However, it is also hypothesized that textually enhanced bilingual subtitles will hinder viewers' comprehension of the video content by placing additional demands on their attention. The findings will provide practical implications for the design and use of bilingual subtitles in second language learning.

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Do Chinese-English Bilinguals Activate Phonology in Early L2 Visual Word-Processing?

Presenter(s): Liying Yang, *Victoria University of Wellington*

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Readers in languages with very different writing systems, such as Chinese and English, may adopt different processing strategies optimized to take advantage of how linguistic information is encoded. For example, in alphabetic languages, like English, phonological activation is typically early and automatic, whereas Chinese readers predominantly rely on orthography-to-semantics mappings with phonological access occurring relatively later. But what happens when reading in a second language (L2)? Are Chinese orthography-to-semantics processing strategies transferred to L2-English word reading, or do L2 readers adopt reading processing strategies characteristic of first language (L1) readers?

The present study investigated whether proficient Chinese-English bilinguals activate phonology during L2 English silent reading. This was tested in an experimental study that employed a boundary and fast-priming paradigm with eye-tracking during natural sentence reading. Target words embedded in sentences were initially masked by scrambled letters; when readers' eyes crossed an invisible boundary, the mask first changed to a phonologically-related, semantically-related, or unrelated prime, and then to the target.

Sixty high L2-proficiency Chinese-English bilinguals and sixty L1-English readers took part in the experiment. Preliminary results revealed different priming patterns for the two participant groups. In the phonological priming condition, L1 readers showed consistent facilitation across both early (first-fixation duration, gaze duration) and late (go-past time) eye-movement measures, whereas bilinguals showed no comparable facilitation. In the semantic priming condition, bilinguals showed a tendency toward semantic activation, while L1 readers did not.

These findings suggest that, unlike L1 readers, proficient Chinese-English bilinguals do not appear to automatically activate phonological representations at the early stages of visual word processing. Instead, some evidence of preferential reliance on semantic access was observed, indicating a possible influence of L1 orthography-to-semantics processing strategies on L2 reading. These results challenge universal models of reading and highlight the critical role of L1 reading experience in shaping L2 processing.

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